Optima Academy Online · An Education Experience Company

Anatomy and Physiology — Semester 1 Syllabus

Florida course 2000350 · Grades 11–12 · Fully asynchronous in Canvas

Course at a glance

Course	Anatomy and Physiology (Florida course code 2000350)
Level	High school, grades 11–12
Delivery	Fully asynchronous in Canvas, with weekly virtual-reality (VR) work in ENGAGE using the HoloAnatomy environment
Semester 1 length	17 weeks: 16 weeks of modules plus a finals week (Quarter 1 = Modules 1–4, Quarter 2 = Modules 5–7 and Finals Week)
School	Optima Academy Online

Course description

This course studies the human body by asking two questions of every structure: *what is it?* and *what does it do?* Form follows function, and each module ties the shape of a structure to the work it performs. Semester 1 begins with how the body is organized, then builds the body system by system: tissues and the skin, the skeleton, muscle, the nervous system, the endocrine system and the cardiovascular system. Systems are never treated in isolation; each lesson points out the connections to the systems around it.

Optima Academy Online teaches in the classical liberal arts tradition and is virtue-centered. Each module carries a virtue thread that runs through its lessons (listed below). The course also uses spatial computing: in most lessons you build the part of the body you are studying in VR, so that by the end of a module you have assembled it yourself.

What you will study

Module	System	When	Quarter	Virtue thread
1	Introduction to Anatomy & Physiology	Week 1	Q1	Wonder
2	Tissues & the Integumentary System	Week 2	Q1	Wonder
3	Skeletal System	Weeks 3–5	Q1	Perseverance
4	Muscular System	Weeks 6–8	Q1	Self-government
5	Nervous System	Weeks 9–11	Q2	Courage
6	Endocrine System	Weeks 12–13	Q2	Courtesy
7	Cardiovascular System	Weeks 14–16	Q2	Service
—	Finals Week: review lesson, review activity, comprehensive final	Week 17	Q2	—

How each week works

Each full week of a module is built the same way, so you always know what to do next:

- **Four readings.** Each reading introduces a topic in plain language, with figures, history-of-science notes and contemporary research where they fit.
- **Four lessons,** one paired with each reading. A lesson gives you 2–4 activities and, in most weeks, a VR session. Plan roughly 75–95 minutes per lesson.
- **Four assignments,** one paired with each lesson, each with a rubric you can read before you start.
- **One reading quiz** at the end of the week: multiple choice, true/false and matching, auto-graded.

Each module also has one **writing assignment** (an essay that pairs a structure with its function) and one **VR snapshot** (a module-end submission of the figure you assembled in ENGAGE, with a short caption). Modules 1 and 2 are single-week modules, so their writing assignments and VR snapshots are shorter.

What you need

- Access to Canvas and a reliable way to open the reading, lesson and assignment pages.
- ENGAGE with the HoloAnatomy environment for the weekly VR sessions.
- A way to record yourself speaking (a phone or a recording app). Several activities ask you to talk through an idea aloud, in your own words and from memory, rather than write it.

- A notebook and pen or pencil for sketches, tables and notes.

How you will be assessed

Category	Items	Points
Lesson Assignments	64	784
Module Writing Assignments	7	188
VR Snapshot Submissions	7	155
Reading Quizzes	16	138
Semester Finals	2	74
Total	**96**	**1339**

Totals count every graded item in the Semester 1 course shell except one optional Module 2 assignment (Cancer: When Cell Division Breaks Down, 8 points); your teacher decides whether it counts toward your grade. How the categories are weighted, and the grading scale, are set by your teacher and school.

Reading quizzes and the final exam are graded automatically. Assignments are graded by your teacher against the rubric printed at the bottom of each assignment page. Read the rubric first; it tells you exactly what a strong submission contains.

Finals week

Finals Week has three parts, taken in this order: the **Review Lesson** (a tour of all seven modules, no new content), the **Review Activity** (a six-system comparative chart, 24 points) and the **Semester 1 Comprehensive Final** (50 questions drawn from the readings of every module, one attempt).

Policies

Late-work, communication and grading-scale policies are set by your teacher and school, and your teacher will share them with you. If you have a technical problem capturing or exporting your VR work in ENGAGE, contact your teacher before the due date.

Sources

Course readings are adapted from OpenStax *Anatomy & Physiology 2e* (openstax.org) into Optima's voice. Image credits appear beneath each figure.